

COLUMN | SANDEEP PARASRAMPURIA

20 thrilling technologies that will change lives 20 years from now.

Before we look at 2040, let's take a quick trip down memory lane to 20 years past. Life at the start of the new millennium was completely unlike today and filled with technology that is no longer known to the modern generation. Landlines, Floppy Disks, VCRs, Phonebooks, Copiers, Film cameras went from awesome to obsolete really quickly.

It is interesting to think of where the digital world will be headed by 2040. Today's technology will seem primitive by the standards of 2041, just as 2001's technology is to us today.

Let's imagine how fascinating 2041 could be!

1. Virtual cloud on-the-go. Data and information might be available virtually as air. Everything on the go will take on a literal meaning and the word "connect" will be meaningless of your gadgets. Imagine wherever you are – in an elevator, a car, or an airplane; data will just move seamlessly.
2. AI will make you believe the world revolves around you! As you talk, discuss, act – AI will surround you with options and suggestions, actionable at a tap or a wink! AI will resemble RI (Real Intelligence)
3. Driverless and automated intelligent cars will move, self-park and maybe fly as well?
4. People's job profiles will change. They will need to work less, and most routine and hazardous work will be covered by robots.
5. Typing on gadgets may be redundant and will be replaced by voice commands, gestures and maybe even thought controls.
6. Local/Vernacular languages will no longer be barriers to trade and travel. On the go translations of spoken and written language will ensure a global world and smoother travel.
7. Green energy will be affordable and freely available. A quieter lifestyle will actually be a reality with vehicles running on clean, renewable power sources.
8. Virtual charging surfaces will be ubiquitous, allowing effortless charging of gadgets on table-tops or car dashboards/surfaces.
9. Space Tourism will turn from fantasy into a reality! Holidays to Mars, round trip around Venus and perhaps, some may prefer to settle permanently in space!
10. Medical treatments, especially surgery, will be robotics driven for high precision.
11. All gadgets will be connected to the cloud. IoT will be way of life.
12. Robots and Cobots – Most of the routine workforce will be replaced by robots partially or, completely giving rise to the term Cobots i.e. Colleagues that are Robots.
13. Personal banking and professional banking will see massive developments with blockchain technology making it faster and secure. I won't be surprised if physical money and physical banking concepts vanished or become limited to very specific scenarios that are uncommon.
14. Physical credit cards will be replaced by virtual limits in your wallets, guarded by biometrics.
15. Computers/Laptops will be thin and practically weightless. Even foldable, or rollable, enabling



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you store it easily and activate it seeming from nowhere.

16. Remote business meetings will be conducted virtually as a standard. Travel might become purely recreational. Business travels will be limited to at the behest of those at the highest echelons, denoting a person's power and wealth.
 17. Wearable gadgets will be indispensable. They will be miniaturised and may be even inserted in ones' body. Information and entertainment will revolve around these gadgets.
 18. Wearable gadgets will also act as medical warning devices to preempt disorders and take required actions in the nick of time.
 19. Every home will have the equivalent of a theatre, with 60+ inch displays installed and a plethora of content accessible on the cloud. Releases will be cloud first.
 20. 3D Printing will be used to construct buildings, structures, and some products within a matter of hours/days which currently take months and years to do.
- Welcome to 2040 – A New Digital World – more comfortable, connected, and with effortless living! 📱